



YOU ARE **19 WEEKS AND 2 DAYS**

145 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

Your baby is increasingly using their hands and feet to explore their surroundings. All limbs have a full and unobstructed range of movement and the fingertips especially are extremely sensitive. Most of their movements are reflex responses at this stage.

“ Comfortably floating in their fluid-filled amniotic sac, your baby is made up almost completely of water. ”

Because water can travel through the skin and the baby is floating in amniotic fluid, their water content is really high, nearly 90 percent. As your baby's skin thickens and becomes less permeable, and their kidneys better regulate the amount of water lost in the urine, their proportion of water will reduce to 70 percent at delivery and again to about 60 percent by the age of 10 as kidney function continues to improve.

Fluids conduct sound waves, but the inner ear is still immature and it will be three weeks before a startle response to sounds can be reliably seen on a scan. As both the uterine wall and the ear drums become thinner, they will gradually respond to higher frequencies and quieter sounds.

NUTRITIOUS SARDINES

Canned sardines are a highly nutritious food. A can of sardines provides omega-3, iron, zinc, vitamin B12 and—if you eat the bones—calcium, too. Try having them on toast or add them to a salad.

LOW-LYING PLACENTA

Placenta previa is when the placenta is either partially covering (incomplete) or completely covering (complete) the cervix. In complete placenta previa, the baby cannot be born vaginally. Complete previa poses a high risk of heavy bleeding, either in late pregnancy or during the actual labor, which is treated as an emergency. If a low-lying placenta is detected at your 20-week scan, you will be scanned again at about 34 weeks; the placenta may “move up” as the uterus grows and no longer be low. In some cases of complete previa, you may be advised to stay in the hospital in later pregnancy in case you have a heavy bleed.